Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in honor of our parents, Brian & Kristy Thomas, on the occasion of their 25th wedding anniversary.

— Landon & Peyton Thomas

Ecclesiastes 4:9–12

Announcements

Every Member Canvass. Baskets are available at each entrance for you to place your "Time & Talents Form." Envelopes are also provided to submit your "EMC Commitment Card." Please place them in the baskets as you enter or exit the sanctuary. Extra EMC booklets are available at each entrance as well. If you would like to submit these items electronically, please scan the QR code on the back of the pew, then click on "Every Member Canvass" on the church website.

Samaritan's Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children's wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs $10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

37th Community Thanksgiving Meal. Join us on Thanksgiving morning, Thursday, November 26, as we prepare and deliver 750 Thanksgiving meals to those who need them throughout Alcorn County. This is a HUGE project and can only be accomplished with the help of many. It is a great opportunity for the members of FPC to be disciples by "living and loving like Jesus." Please complete the insert to volunteer your time and place it in the offering plate, or bring it to the church office.

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Dave Shanklin

Greeters — Garett & Mary Elizabeth Pounders

Acolytes — Blair Bryant & John Butler

Circle of Prayer — Alberto Albarracin & Becky Stewart

Children's Church — Ken & Edi Williams

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Ushers — Bubba Labas, Randy Lambert, Alan Smith, & Henry Labas

Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Courtney Monaghan, Sallie Kate Williams, Katty Albarracin, Abby Moore, Tara Mathis, & Jeannie Blackwelder

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor
Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship
Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care
Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries
Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women's Min. & Comm.
Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director
Jan Pike - Choir Director
Malechi Doren - Accompanist
Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant
Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

October 25 Commitment Sunday for the Every Member Canvass
October 27 Messy Bible Study
October 28 Kids Quest · Messy Bible Study · Youth House
November 26 37th Community Thanksgiving Meal

Online Giving

Scan to give online

919 East Shiloh Rd · Corinth, MS 38834 · fpccorinth.org · 662-286-6638

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

October 25, 2026

Reformation Sunday

"To be disciples, to make disciples"

A congregation of the Evangelical Presbyterian Church

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew, or scan the QR code and submit it on your phone. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children's Church during the service. Children's bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God's Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by "Being Disciples and Making Disciples."

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

"Excel in Giving"

Rev. Waring Porter · 2 Corinthians 8:7

As we look around First Presbyterian Church, we have much for which to give thanks. We see the Lord at work. We see people growing in their faith, serving others, caring for one another, and being equipped for the work of ministry. We see disciples making disciples. These are signs of His grace among us. But as we give thanks for what God is doing, we also need to ask ourselves a deeper question: Are we growing as disciples of Jesus in every area of our lives?

Paul is writing to a church that has demonstrated spiritual growth in many areas. He lists five of them. Even though they are excelling in these areas, he wants them to grow in one more area: the grace of giving. We are not talking about simply giving more money… not simply meeting a budget… and not simply keeping the church's ministries funded. We are talking about the grace of generosity as an expression of Christian discipleship — who we are because we are following Jesus, being changed by Jesus, and living/loving like Jesus.

We are going to see three things in this verse that show us the process for how we can excel in the grace of giving.

I. Grace Produces Generosity

Psalm 24:1 — "The earth is the LORD's and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell therein."

II. Generosity Requires Growth

Matthew 6:21 — "For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also."

III. Generosity Reflects the Grace of Christ

2 Corinthians 8:9 — "For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor, so that you by his poverty might become rich."

We do not give in order to become recipients of God's grace.
We give because, in Jesus Christ, we already are.

Scripture Reading *2 Corinthians 8:7 (NIV) · Pew Bible, p. 967*

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;

All: *The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever. Amen.*

Sermon: *"Excel in Giving"* *Rev. Waring Porter*

EVERY MEMBER CANVASS

FPC's annual stewardship campaign, as we prepare for a new year of ministry. We commit to giving our time, talents, and treasures as a response to the gospel: Christ gave Himself for us, and we now belong to Him, including all that we are and all that He has entrusted to us. This approach also keeps these commitments in their proper place. They are not a means of earning God's favor, but the fruit of His grace working in His people.

Every Member Canvass *Dr. John Shipp*

Chairman

"But since you excel in everything: in faith, in speech, in knowledge, in complete earnestness and in the love we have kindled in you, see that you also excel in this grace of giving." *2 Corinthians 8:7 (NIV)*

Prayer of Dedication

SENDING

O JESUS, I HAVE PROMISED

This closing hymn connects the commitments made during worship with the ongoing call to follow Christ in our daily lives.

***Hymn: #369** *"O Jesus, I Have Promised"*

***Benediction**

***Choral Benediction** *"Go Now in Peace"*

***Postlude**

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

October 25, 2026

** Indicates congregation standing if able*

GATHERING

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: 2 Corinthians 8:7 (NIV)

"But since you excel in everything: in faith, in speech, in knowledge, in complete earnestness and in the love we have kindled in you, see that you also excel in this grace of giving."

The Prelude

Choral Introit *"In Your House"*

***Call to Worship:** taken from Psalm 116:12–14, 17–19

Leader: What shall we render to the LORD for all His benefits to us?

All: *We will lift up the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the LORD.*

Leader: We will offer to God a sacrifice of thanksgiving and call upon the name of the LORD.

All: *We will fulfill our vows to the LORD in the presence of all His people.*

Leader: Let us worship the Lord, from whom every good gift comes, and who has given us the greatest gift of all in His Son, Jesus Christ.

All: *To God alone be the glory!*

CALL TO WORSHIP

We are summoned to worship by God's word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God's call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God's initiative, not ours.

***The Hymn: #8** *"Praise to the Lord, the Almighty" (vv. 1–3)*

PRAISE TO THE LORD, THE ALMIGHTY

This hymn was written in 1680 by Joachim Neander, a German Reformed hymnwriter, and translated into English by Catherine Winkworth in 1863. Drawing especially on Psalms 103 and 150, this beloved hymn celebrates God's sovereign majesty, faithful providence, and saving grace. As we sing, it draws our attention to God's character and His provision.

***Prayer of Invocation & The Lord's Prayer**

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

***Responsive Reading:** 1 Chronicles 29:10–14

Leader: David praised the Lord in the presence of the whole assembly, saying,

All: *Praise be to you, Lord, the God of our father Israel, from everlasting to everlasting.*

Leader: Yours, Lord, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the majesty and the splendor, for everything in heaven and earth is yours.

All: *Yours, Lord, is the kingdom; you are exalted as head over all. Wealth and honor come from you; you are the ruler of all things.*

Leader: In your hands are strength and power to exalt and give strength to all.

All: *Now, our God, we give you thanks, and praise your glorious name.*

Leader: But who am I, and who are my people, that we should be able to give as generously as this?

All: *Everything comes from you, and we have given you only what comes from your hand.*

***Congregational Response: #8** *"Praise to the Lord, the Almighty" (v. 4)*

CORPORATE CONFESSION

Our corporate confession of sin is a three-fold acknowledgement that the world is not the way it was meant to be; I am not the way I was meant to be; and we as a church are not the way we were meant to be. As we acknowledge our failures together, we testify to the world that the gospel is rooted in the faithful mercy of God alone. This is the most honest moment of our week, as we humbly agree with Scripture's claim that all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious Father, we confess that we have often treated our time, abilities, and possessions as our own rather than as gifts entrusted to us by You. We have been selfish in our service, anxious about our resources, and reluctant to give generously for the good of others and the advancement of Your kingdom. Forgive us for the sake of Jesus Christ, who became poor for our sake that we might become rich in Him. By Your Holy Spirit, renew our hearts, deepen our gratitude for Your abundant grace, and teach us to offer our whole lives willingly and joyfully for Your glory. In Jesus' name we pray.

Silent Confession

Assurance of Divine Pardon: Ephesians 1:7–8

"In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins, in accordance with the riches of God's grace that he lavished on us. With all wisdom and understanding,"

***Hymn of Response: #202** *"Amazing Grace" (vv. 1–3)*

A Moment for Missions *Roca Blanca Mission Trip*

Katty Albarracin, Maribel Albarran, & Malechi Doren

WORD

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

Choral Anthem *"I Call to the Lord"*

Nan Allen & Dennis Allen

***The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication**

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

***Children Dismissed to Children's Church**

CHILDREN'S CHURCH

Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children's Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.